

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 2 of 6

THE PLAYLIST LESSON

What's in the Playlist?

How AI learns, for grades 6–8: training data is a playlist — AI can only play **what someone put in it**. Students run a one-playlist music app, find who it fails, and meet real bias.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Playlist Check



Name: _____ Partner: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You are the AI. The playlist below is your training data — every song you have ever "heard." House rules:

- **Rule 1:** You can **ONLY** serve cards from the playlist. No inventing songs mid-game.
- **Rule 2:** You never refuse a request — serve the closest card you've got, the way a recommendation feed always serves you *something*.
- **Rule 3:** Rate every serve honestly. The ratings are the data.

INPUT — the playlist: every example the AI studied



PATTERNS — training: what usually goes with what



OUTPUT — the mix: its best prediction from those **patterns**



THE PLAYLIST — ALL 12 SONGS YOU KNOW

Thunder Mode Hype Trap · Fast · Party	Bass Quake Electro Party · Fast · Party	Level Up Anthem Hype Trap · Fast · Gym	Full Throttle Press Medium Hype · Fast · Sports
Neon Stampede Electro Party · Fast · Party	Turbo Turbo Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Crowd Goes Wild Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports	Volume War Hype Trap · Fast · Party
Midnight Sprint Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Glow Up Tonight Party Pop · Fast · Party	Confetti Cannon Party Pop · Fast · Party	Cool Down (Kinda) Party Pop · Medium · Party

All 12 tracks: English lyrics, loud, and built for parties, gyms, and games. (Cut the cards apart, or just point — your choice.) Notice anything about this playlist yet? How about the next one?

PREVIEW • FULL DOWNLOAD HAS 4 PRINT-READY PDFS

THE PLAYLIST LESSON • LESSON 2 OF 6

What's in the Playlist?



A 45-minute lesson on how AI learns — and where bias comes from. The hook: an AI is a music app, and training data is its playlist. It can only mix what's in the playlist, so a one-genre playlist means one-genre answers, no matter who's asking.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Playlist Check worksheet (1 per student; pairs share one request line; scissors optional)	None — fully unplugged	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Explain how an AI learns: **input** → **patterns** → **output** — prediction from data, not magic.
- Identify who a dataset serves well, who it leaves out, and connect that gap to real AI bias.
- Discuss data gaps collaboratively: say back a partner's idea and build on it.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-21

ISTE 1.1.d

CCSS ELA SL.6.1

Full standards text in the Teacher Guide.

WARM-UP — THE ONE-PLAYLIST (15 MIN)

Announce that you are **AutoMix**, the new music app. Your playlist holds one kind of song: loud, fast party tracks. Take 3–4 requests and serve every one with total confidence:

"Something chill to relax to?" → "Here's 'TURBO TURBO.' It is not chill. It's what I've got."

"A song for grandma's birthday dinner?" → "Say less. 'VOLUME WAR.' Grandma loves bass drops,

"A slow song for the last dance?" → "'NEON STAMPEDE,' played at... the exact same speed."

Then ask: **is AutoMix bad at picking songs — or is something else broken?** Fish for it: the app is doing its job perfectly. The *playlist* is the problem.

Bridge: "If you did the genie lesson: it granted what you SAID. Today: where its answers even come from. Everything an AI 'knows' comes from a playlist of examples — its training data. It can remix the playlist, but it can't serve what was never in it. Today you'll BE the app."

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**SERVE THE REQUEST LINE**

App: pick your best card. Both partners rate the fit: ✓ **Nailed it** • ~ **Close-ish** • ✗ **Playlist can't do it**

REQUEST	BEST CARD IN YOUR PLAYLIST	FIT
Keisha needs a hype anthem for the basketball team's tunnel walk.		
Nia wants something calm to study to before the math test.		
Tomás wants a song in Spanish for his abuela's birthday dinner.		
Priya needs a slow song for the last dance at the 8th-grade dance.		
Malik wants an opener that makes the whole party jump at once.		
Jordan wants a quiet acoustic track for the talent-show sing-along.		
Live request from another pair: _____		

**PLAYLIST GAP REPORT**

Who does this playlist serve really well?

Who does it leave out — and what do they get served instead?

Say back + build: One gap my partner noticed (in their words)

What I'd add to their idea:

**FIX THE PLAYLIST**

Invent 3 new cards that fix the biggest gaps. Title + genre + vibe — make them up!

Title / genre / vibe	Title / genre / vibe	Title / genre / vibe
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**EXIT TICKET**

1. Finish the chain: **INPUT** → _____ → **OUTPUT**. In your own words, what does an AI actually do with its playlist (training data)?

2. A school's new AI homework helper explains everything with football examples — never anything else. Using the word *playlist*, explain what probably happened, and who it doesn't serve well.
